

Speedway during an Auto Fair back in September. The aim of the this hovercar is to bring standard hovercraft technology and combine it with the style and elegance of sports cars. A hovercraft, essentially, is the ideal all-terrain vehicle. The Mercier-Jones Hovercraft aims at making it a commercially viable option by incorporating construction techniques from automotive, marine and aerospace design. It's also "inspired by elements of the Bugatti Veyron, Maserati Gran Turismo, Audi R8 and other sports cars" - A fact that people will agree with at first glance. It's not, however, a very practical option as of now with a fuel capacity of 38 litres, a quoted cruise speed of 56 km/hr and a mileage of about 7.4 km/litre. On the other hand when you own a car that floats 8 inches off the ground - well, enough said.

This project spent quite a long time in the pipeline, and the fall of their Indiegogo campaign didn't really help the situation; But after getting up after that fall, the Mercier-Jones Hovercraft has announced a Summer release in 2014.

"Hello, Jarvis."

When Tony Stark first used the space around him as his personal virtual corkboard, admit it, you were blown. Why wouldn't you be?

In May 2012 Michael Buckwald, David Holz and their team announced the launch of 'The Leap' - a motion sensor technology that would emulate similar hand-gestures on your own PC. This device launched in July 2013 and was met with cynicism on several fronts. People complained that it did not live up to its hype. The Leap Motion controller was well-designed and impressive from the technology point of view. The users' main complaint was the fact that it wasn't very productive for daily use. A lot of people felt like they had just 'experienced a gimmick' instead of trying out something that could be the next stage of user interface evolution. This is, however, a viewpoint held by a few, and it's quite valid. However, practice makes perfect. Check out this link to see a person play *Borderlands 2* completely via Leap motion. <http://dgit.in/hawaameingolimaar>

On a more scientific note, Elon Musk, the American business magnate and reputed inventor merged Leap with NX

Siemens to create a gesture-controlled designing program to make it easier for people to design three-dimensional models of prototype designs. In his demonstration (<http://dgit.in/therealStark>) he shows it's relatively fluid functionality. It seems like the 'real world Tony Stark is really living up to his name.

The end of all drivers

Remember how annoyed Quaid got with his robot cab driver in *Total Recall*? Well, robot driver aside, there have been several steps taken in the field of automated driving. Two major breakthroughs were made by Google and a European company called '2getthere Cabs'.

2getthere Cabs has had several projects dealing with the integration of PRT (Personal Rapid Transit) and GRT (Group Rapid Transit) systems in places that can afford it. Their systems run on AGV (Automated Guided Vehicle) Systems created by Frog Technology. With the kind of efficiency 2getthere has introduced, it very nearly represents the next generation of public transport.

Google on the other hand aims at the general populous with its Google Driverless car. these cars host about \$150,000 in equipment. The cars sport a LIDAR (laser radar) system along with a mounted range finder - a Velodyne 64-beam laser. This allows the vehicle to generate a detailed 3D map of its environment which generates maps and combines them with high-resolution world maps that make it easier for the car to drive itself.

As seen in the test run made by Steve Mahan (<http://dgit.in/driver1355>) an old man who's slowly losing his eyesight, the car runs quite smoothly.



2getthere Cabs: The future of public transport?



Scanadu: Your doctor at home

Dammit, Jim! I'm a Doctor, not a Scanadu!

Where would Bones or any other doctor on *Star Trek* be without their medical tricorders? A handheld device that scans a body for anomalies

Scanadu, a Silicon Valley-based company decided to take one of the first steps towards a Trekkie-centric idealistic galaxy. Introducing the Scanadu Scout - a device a bit larger than a pacemaker. This little device fulfils the role of a doctor's first opinion at home. Once placed on your forehead, It scans the body and symptoms and gives you a diagnosis. Based on this diagnosis, it will either give you a recommended treatment or at least tell you if its something that will go away, or something serious enough for you to admit the patient in the nearest hospital.

Though still going through some final tweaks, the device has great potential.

Iris, log me in.

Gaming is in constant need of innovation to keep up with its target audience. Gamers always want something bigger, more realistic and, essentially, better than